MIL-C-37026A
28 November 1978
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-37026
8 January 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CURETTE, ENDOMETRIAL BIOPSY, CURVED, 11-3/4 INCH, DISPOSABLE, 12s

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a sterile, disposable aspirating device for use in collecting specimens for the detection of endometrial cancer.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-636	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-S-36586	Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6515

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DRAWING

DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER (DPSC)

24382 - Curette, Endometrial Biopsy,Disposable.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States (USP)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE
FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations
Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Components. The endometrial biopsy curette shall consist of an aspirating cannula with attached cap, plastic protector for cannula, container, filter, captive plug, dispatch lid, plastic bag and tie tape. Instructions for use shall also be supplied.

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Polyethylene. The slotted filter shall be fabricated from low density polyethylene suitable for the intended purpose.

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3.2.2 Polypropylene. The container, attached cannula cap, captive plug, dispatch lid and plastic protector for cannula tip shall be fabricated from polypropylene suitable for the intended purpose.

3.2.3 Stainless steel. The stainless steel cannula tube shall be fabricated from Class 3, type 304 material in accordance with GG-I-526.

3.3 Style, design and dimensions. The endometrial biopsy curette shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing 24382. It shall be capable of operation from a central vacuum source or a vacuum pump at 160-260 millimeters (mm) Hg gage pressure.

3.4 Sterility. The endometrial biopsy curette shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.1.

3.4.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include.

a. Item identification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of a laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, Technical Operations Division, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

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3.4.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and sterilized simultaneously in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.5 Corrosion resistance. The stainless steel cannula shall show no sign of corrosion when subjected to the boil test specified in GG-I-526.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Curettes shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the plastics and stainless steel may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

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4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one curette.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5

4.2.2 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table II. Where feasible the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Dimensions	3.3	---	S-1	1/
Sterility	3.4	4.4.1	2/	1/
Boil test	3.5	GG-I-526	S-2	2.5

1/ Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.
2/ Sampling shall be as indicated for parenteral devices in the USP.

4.3 Examination. The curette shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table III. Examination shall not be restricted to classified possible defects listed in table III.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Stainless steel tube not smoothly finished.
102	Plastic components not free of pits, blisters, scratches, cracks, nicks, bubbles, roughness, tackiness, bloom or crazing.
Minor	
201	Packaging, packing or marking not as specified.
202	Instructions missing, incomplete or illegible.

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4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Sterility test. The curettes shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for transfusion and infusion assemblies using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in 4.4.1.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for type I sterilization and 30 for type II sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in table II.

4.4.1.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.4.1.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used, shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.1 and 4.4.1.1. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for, as shown in 4.4.1.1.

When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

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4.4.1.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.4.1.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the Government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing twelve individually packaged curettes constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Individual packaging. Each device, consisting of an aspirating cannula, specimen container with captive plug, a dispatch lid, plastic bag tie tape and instructions for use shall be packaged in a sealed peel-open type pouch of an appropriate size and design. The pouch shall be so designed to facilitate easy opening. The pouch shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened and shall not be capable of being resealed. Each pouch may be further packaged in a paperboard box of an appropriate size and design. Closure of the box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2.2 Unit package. Twelve individually packaged curettes (aspirating devices) shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. Twelve curettes (aspirating devices), individually packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1, shall be packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

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5.2.1 Level A. Eight unit packages shall be packaged in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Eight unit packages shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged curettes shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package.

5.3.1.1 Pouch. Each pouch shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of the Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. In addition to any commercial markings, the pouch shall also be marked with the item identification, sterility lot (control) number, instructions for opening the pouch and the legend "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS POUCH IS DAMAGED OR OPENED" or similar statement. Instructions for use shall be printed on the pouch or shall be inserted within the pouch.

5.3.1.2 Box. When furnished, each box shall be marked in accordance with the contractor's commercial practice and may have the instructions for use placed on the box in lieu of the pouch.

5.3.2 Unit packages. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number and name and address of the contractor shall be shown. The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, C-Cold, D-Dry Heat) shall be shown following the level of packaging and the date of packaging. Example: "A-12/73-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number shall be shown. The method of sterilization specified in 5.3.2 shall be shown.

When the contractor is not the manufacturer, the name and address of the manufacturer shall also be shown on the bag and unit package.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The curettes are intended for collecting specimens for the detection of endometrial cancer by vacuum curettage.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 NSN coverage. This specification covers the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-149-0332	CURETTE, ENDOMETRIAL BIOPSY, Curved, 11-3/4 inch, Disposable, 12s

6.4 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DLA - DM

Project No. 6515-2167

Review activity:
DOD - MB

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-C-37026A CURETTE, ENDOMETRIAL BIOPSY, CURVED, 11-3/4 INCH, DISPOSABLE, 12s

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

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